

Being really light on system resources, VirtualDub is often the only tool that most people can afford to run on older computers. Even if you have a top-of-the-line system, and just want to quickly compress movies and do a little bit of basic editing, you will find VirtualDub more than sufficient. The most visible feathers in its cap are:

- At just under 1 MB, it's quite literally the smallest video editing software out there, so even people on dial-up connections can easily download it.
- Being open source, it's constantly being improved, and plugins and filters are being developed all the time. Try <http://neuron2.net> for some cool filters.
- It's free!

4.1.3 Avid FreeDV

www.avid.com/freedv

Avid, makers of professional video editing software, have a free tool called Avid Free DV that is available for download from the site mentioned above. It's nagware, in the sense that every time you start Free DV, it keeps prompting you to buy the professional tools that Avid makes. Apart from that, however, this software is quite brilliant. We expected to find crippled software, and expected to be nagged to pay for almost every non-standard effect or function, but neither of these happened.

Free DV uses an approach quite different from other editing software, and the novice will have a tough time getting used to the interface. A complete newbie might not be as flummoxed as those of us who have used Windows Movie Maker, VirtualDub, Adobe Premiere Pro, or any of the popular editing software, because it's the habit of the standard editor's usability that one has to overcome.

Free DV uses Bins (a holder for clips and pictures, so you can easily access a selection of audio and video clips or images) to store your clips, and we've heard of some people who just couldn't even get started editing—simply because they couldn't find where to